From	Robert Samuel White
To	[Tugman Volunteer Services Lead]
Date	December 15, 2024, 10:08 AM PT
Subject	**Volunteer Yurt/Cabin Host Position at Umpqua Lighthouse State Park**
Document	01JF5MNXQ0DD3JPZ68HWYSKRYX

Dear [Tugman Volunteer Services Lead],

I hope this message finds you well. My name is Robert Samuel White (Sam), and I was recently encouraged to apply for a volunteer host position within Oregon State Parks by Matt, a host at Cape Blanco, and Jerry, a park ranger I've come to know at both Cape Blanco and Humbug Mountain State Parks. Both have spoken positively about my time here and expressed their willingness to vouch for me as a strong candidate.

Over the past two months, I've been living and engaging deeply with the southern Oregon coast, where I feel a profound sense of belonging. After a month-long journey from Kentucky, I arrived here and knew almost immediately I was "home." I've been exploring this landscape—its lighthouses, rugged beaches, and trails—with reverence and a strong desire to contribute meaningfully to its preservation and maintenance. I'm committed to staying along the 101 for the long term and would be honored to support Oregon's State Parks through volunteer service.

The Yurt/Cabin Host position at Umpqua Lighthouse State Park aligns perfectly with my skills, strengths, and current way of life. I am deeply organized, hardworking, and accustomed to the physical tasks required, such as cleaning, light landscaping, and general maintenance. I also value providing excellent visitor experiences and creating welcoming, well-kept spaces for all who come to enjoy these parks. I am fully capable of meeting the role's requirements and bring with me not only practical skills but a personal connection to the parks I would serve.

If you have time for a conversation, I'd greatly appreciate the opportunity to discuss this position and learn more about the expectations and application process. I currently have limited internet access while camped at Humbug Mountain, but I can find connectivity for any necessary next steps.

Thank you for your time and consideration. I look forward to the possibility of contributing to the incredible work being done across Oregon State Parks. Please feel free to reach out via email or phone at your earliest convenience.

Warm regards,
Robert Samuel White

From	Robert Samuel White
To	[Tugman Volunteer Services Lead]
Date	December 15, 2024, 10:23 AM PT
Subject	**Re: Volunteer Yurt/Cabin Host Position at Umpqua Lighthouse State Park**
Attached	Robert-Samuel-White-Park-Host-Volunteer-Application.pdf
Document	01JF5NGZXRMGNWAEV6J8Y74FMR

I've submitted my formal application!

From: Robert Samuel White
Sent: Sunday, December 15, 2024 9:08:28 AM
To: [Tugman Volunteer Services Lead]
Subject: Volunteer Yurt/Cabin Host Position at Umpqua Lighthouse State Park

Dear [Tugman Volunteer Services Lead],

I hope this message finds you well. My name is Robert Samuel White (Sam), and I was recently encouraged to apply for a volunteer host position within Oregon State Parks by Matt, a host at Cape Blanco, and Jerry, a park ranger I've come to know at both Cape Blanco and Humbug Mountain State Parks. Both have spoken positively about my time here and expressed their willingness to vouch for me as a strong candidate.

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Warm regards,
Robert Samuel White

From	[Tugman Volunteer Services Lead]
To	Robert Samuel White
Date	December 15, 2024, 5:20 PM PT
Subject	**RE: Volunteer Yurt/Cabin Host Position at Umpqua Lighthouse State Park**
Attached	Umpqua-Tugman Volunteer Program Info.docx, Brochure - Tugman.pdf, Brochure - Umpqua.pdf, Site Directory - Tugman.pdf, Site Directory - Umpqua.pdf
Document	01JF6DCCMGDYD32J25GASFY5RE

Hi Sam,
This is a very thoughtful email, I'd be quite happy to talk to you some more about the host program. I'm about to start my weekend but I will be available starting Wednesday if you'd like to set up a phone call? Usually takes about 30 minutes, just to get to know you a little better and answer any questions you may have. For now I have attached a document with some more information about the program in our specific Management Unit (administrative divisions of Oregon State Parks. I oversee the volunteer program for both Umpqua Lighthouse and Tugman). I have also included brochures for both parks and the host site directories which have more information about the amenities.

It would be helpful to know what months you are hoping to schedule. If you're wanting to start immediately, I do have an open position from January 1 - 31 at Tugman, which is the Yurt Cleaner position that is described in the info document.

Warm regards,

[OPRD-shield_RGB_R BLACK]

[Tugman Volunteer Services Lead] (She/her) | Park Ranger + Volunteer Service Leader

From	Robert Samuel White
To	[Tugman Volunteer Services Lead]
Date	December 16, 2024, 9:50 AM PT
Subject	**Re: Volunteer Yurt/Cabin Host Position at Umpqua Lighthouse State Park**
Attached	1000026982.jpg
Document	01JF861F682PAKVQ6TGG4ERYMB

Thank you for such a welcoming response! Wednesday would be perfect for a call -- I'll be traveling that day, moving back to Cape Blanco for the holidays.

The January position at Tugman is perfect timing. I've been exploring the 101 since arriving from Kentucky, finding my place along this coast. Your Management Unit sits right between my familiar territory and new areas I want to explore -- it feels like an ideal next step.

My availability is wide open. I'm looking to transition from programming into park service work, whether that's seasonal ranging, maintenance, or other opportunities. In the meantime (or perhaps in conjunction), I'd like to deepen my ties to this coast through volunteer opportunities -- if you let me know when and where I'm needed, I can plan around it.

I should also expand on what I mentioned in my application about Humbug Mountain. The injury wasn't just from one enthusiastic descent -- it was from continuing to hike ten miles daily for eight weeks afterward, exploring every trail from Brookings to Bandon. Cape Blanco, Cape Sebastian, Pistol River, Loeb, the Samuel H. Boardman corridor... I wanted to know these parks intimately.

When my body finally demanded rest, I listened -- spent two weeks healing at Cape Blanco (long enough that Jerry noticed my absence!). I'm much better now, though I might need to pace myself a bit below my natural intensity level.

I mention this because it shows both my dedication to these parks and my ability to adjust when needed -- even if it takes me a while to listen!

I'd love to learn more about both immediate and longer-term possibilities in your parks. Here's a photo of me from today (my way of showing up). Let me know what time works best for you on Wednesday! Hope you have an excellent "weekend!" 🙃

Sam

From	Robert Samuel White
To	[Tugman Volunteer Services Lead]
Date	December 18, 2024, 1:09 PM PT
Subject	**Re: Volunteer Yurt/Cabin Host Position at Umpqua Lighthouse State Park**
Document	01JFDP7WW8WZTR9M9F5WCXSC2D

Hi [Tugman Volunteer Services Lead],

I've just arrived at Cape Blanco. Cell service and internet are fairly reliable here so I'm available to speak anytime for the rest of the day (minus when I move into my site - going to check on that now). Hope you're doing well.

Sam